

bitten by the infectious salesmanship of the enthusiast; its a shame his stories never seem to work out.

- **The Permabear:** The most dangerous clown in the circus, responsible for more wealth destruction than any other player. Any data point has the seeds of destruction within. Every market wobble is a start of the next crash. When things are fine, investors are complacent; when they are less so, it's proof trouble is coming. At least the **Permabulls** have the overall market trend on their side (stocks tend to go up over time). The permabears are fighting a trend in place for centuries, as well as human ingenuity, innovation, and technological progress. That's been a losing bet for millennia.
- **The Doomers:** The world is always on the razor's edge of disaster. Every geopolitical crisis is spiraling into a world war, every credit market hiccup is a new Great Financial Crisis. Economic slowdowns aren't even recessions, they are budding Depressions. Own bottled water, ammo, and farmland far away from the roving murder-gangs? (Hard pass—that's not a life worth living.)
- **The Exotician:** The more obscure, the better: Fascinated by little-known indicators, the exotician flits from style to style like a butterfly seeking nectar. Last week it was Bollinger Bands and McClellan Oscillators, this week it's Elliott Waves. The esoterica masks a lack of conviction for previous ideas. They never stick with any style long enough to test its validity. Instead, they are on a search for a magic bullet that does not exist.
- **The Liar:** All industries have their share of BS artists, but a special type is attracted to trading. They never have a losing position; their buys are always the low tick of the day. And the sells! The best possible print! I can count on one hand the number of times I've top-ticked a stock on the way out;⁶⁴ yet somehow, the Liar manages decades worth of statistically aberrant prices *each day before lunch*.